

CAUTIONS *continued*

KNEE MENISCUS TEAR/INJURY

Be careful of or avoid deep knee flexion, especially if weight bearing.

KNEE REPLACEMENT

Avoid extreme knee flexion; cushion the knee with blankets or padding when in kneeling poses.

LOW BLOOD PRESSURE (HYPOTENSION)

Move slowly out of any pose where the head goes below the heart; pause a few moments in a restful pose, such as Child's pose, after full inversions to prevent dizziness; move slowly when rising from the floor.

MIGRAINE

Be careful when performing full inversions; try practicing in a room with the lights dimmed.

MULTIPLE SCLEROSIS

Be careful of intense practices that make you feel overheated; avoid hot yoga.

OBESITY

Be careful of unsupported spinal flexion and full inversions, such as headstands, shoulderstands, or anything that puts your weight on your neck.

OSTEOPOROSIS/OSTEOPENIA

For spinal areas, talk to your doctor, as what you can do will depend on the severity of your condition.

However, general guidelines are to be careful of unsupported spinal flexion and spinal rotation; move slowly and focus on elongating the spine before coming into twists, and consider flexing at the hips and try keeping the spine neutral in many Forward Folds to avoid the risks of spinal flexion (Child's or Cat pose may be safer forms of spinal flexion); avoid or take extreme caution during headstands, shoulderstands, or anything that puts pressure on the neck; take particular caution to move slowly and gently in movements that combine spinal flexion and rotation such as Triangle pose; take care in transitioning poses and balancing poses to reduce the risk of falling; for nonspinal areas, such as hips or wrists, move slowly into poses and focus on mindfully strengthening muscles around the affected areas.

PARKINSON'S DISEASE

Be careful of inversions and balancing poses; try holding onto the wall or a chair to prevent falls; use props as needed.

PLANTAR FASCIITIS

Avoid or be careful jumping into poses, or any movement that exacerbates symptoms; stretch the feet and legs slowly and mindfully.

PREGNANCY

Be careful of full inversions, especially if you don't already have

an inversion practice; be careful of or avoid anything that puts pressure on the abdomen (e.g. Locust pose or extreme abdominal engagement); avoid extreme abdominal stretching (e.g. Wheel pose); don't stay too long lying on your back in later stages of pregnancy if uncomfortable, and consider lying on your side with a pillow between your legs, or propping yourself up to lie at an angle.

ROTATOR CUFF (TEAR, TENDONITIS, INSTABILITY)

Be careful with any shoulder stretches; avoid Low Plank pose (Chaturanga), particularly in acute stages; focus on strengthening over stretching, e.g. consider holding a forearm version of Plank or Downward Dog on the floor or wall.

SACROILIAC (SI) DYSFUNCTION/PAIN

Avoid extreme twists and be careful in wide-legged postures (e.g. Triangle pose). Being in asymmetric poses, such as Warrior poses or Triangle pose, for a prolonged period on one side may be uncomfortable; if so, consider switching sides more often.

SCIATICA

Be careful of anything that increases numbness; if the condition is due to a tight piriformis, consider modified versions of Pigeon pose, e.g. figure 4 on your back (see p.82).